

Design Review Report

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Teaching Videos

List each teaching video you watched. For each one, write a real takeaway. What concept clicked for you? What surprised you or challenged an assumption you had? What impressed you about how your teammate demonstrated something? Take this seriously. Your teammates put real effort into these videos to teach you something you did not study yourself.

Video

I watched Esther Escobar's video on CSS Masonry.

Takeaway

One of the biggest things that stood out to me was learning why masonry layouts are difficult to achieve with standard CSS Grid. I had never really thought about the fact that Grid forces items to share row heights, which creates the empty gaps that Esther pointed out in her examples. Seeing the visual comparison between a regular grid and a masonry layout helped me understand the problem that masonry is trying to solve.

I was also surprised to learn that one of the common CSS-only workarounds, using column-count, introduces accessibility issues. Esther demonstrated how keyboard navigation follows the document order down each column instead of across the rows, which could be confusing for users relying on keyboards or screen readers. That challenged my assumption that if something looks correct visually, it is automatically a good solution.

What impressed me most was how she walked through several approaches rather than presenting masonry as a simple feature. She explained the limitations of CSS Grid, the trade-offs of the column-count method, and why many developers still rely on Masonry.js today. I also found the discussion about the ongoing development of native CSS masonry interesting because it showed how much debate and consideration goes into adding new features to the web platform.

This video changed the way I think about layout decisions. It reminded me that choosing a technique is not just about achieving a visual effect but also about considering accessibility, browser support, performance, and long-term maintainability.

Video

I watched Enoch Olayemi's video on Scroll Snap Carousel.

Takeaway

What stood out to me most was how CSS Scroll Snap can create carousel-like behavior without requiring JavaScript. Before watching this video, I assumed that snapping effects always involved event listeners and calculations to determine the user's scroll position. Enoch showed that CSS properties alone can handle much of that work, which really simplified my understanding of how these interfaces are built.

The explanation of scroll-snap-type was especially helpful. Seeing the difference between mandatory and proximity made the concept click for me. I had not considered how forcing users to snap to every item could actually create usability issues, especially when the content is longer. The demonstration showed that mandatory provides a more controlled experience, while proximity gives users greater flexibility to stop where they need to. That trade-off between structure and usability was something I had not thought about before.

I was also impressed by the live demonstrations of scroll-snap-align. Watching the snapping behavior change from start to center and end helped me understand how small CSS adjustments can dramatically change the feel of a user interface. The fact that Enoch experimented with the code in real time, even troubleshooting when something did not initially work as expected, made the learning experience feel authentic and practical.

This video changed the way I think about interactive design. Instead of immediately reaching for JavaScript, I would now consider whether modern CSS features like Scroll Snap could accomplish the same goal more simply. I can see this being useful in future projects involving image galleries, featured content sections, or mobile-friendly card layouts where smooth navigation is important.

Code Reviews

Review at least two teammates' Practice Site repositories. Look at their actual code for Choose Topic pages you did not build yourself. Each design review you should choose different teammates to review so that over the course of the semester you cycle through everyone on your team.

Review

I reviewed Enoch's code for their [Not Provided] page.

What You Found

Review

I reviewed Esther's code for their CSS Masonry page.

What You Found

One thing I noticed from reviewing the page was how well organized the demo was. It was not just one example of masonry. It was broken into clear sections: a standard CSS Grid problem, a CSS Columns workaround, a Masonry.js solution, and a future native CSS option. That structure made the code easier to understand because each section had a specific purpose.

Something I found useful was that the page itself explained the trade-offs directly in the content. For example, the CSS Columns section pointed out that it can look like masonry visually, but the tab order goes down the columns instead of across, which creates an accessibility problem. I thought that was a smart thing to include because it showed that the code was not only focused on appearance but also on usability.

I did not notice any major broken styles or structure issues from the live page. The examples seemed intentional, especially the gaps in the standard grid section because those gaps demonstrated the exact problem masonry solves. The main thing I would maybe suggest is adding a little more explanation in the code comments so someone reviewing the files later could quickly understand why each approach was included. Overall, I thought the page was well organized and I liked how it compared multiple layout methods instead of only showing the final solution.

Review

I reviewed Harrison Merrill's code for their Sticky Demo page.

What You Found

One thing I noticed was that Harrison chose a very clear content example for demonstrating sticky positioning. Using Matthew 5 gave the page enough vertical content for the sticky behavior to actually be tested while scrolling. That helped the demo feel more realistic than just using placeholder text.

I also noticed that the page was focused and simple, which made the sticky concept easier to see. The section title and "Stick-ing to the Be-Attitudes" heading made it clear what the demo was trying to teach. I did notice one small typo in the intro text where "Matthew" was spelled "Mathew." It is not a major issue, but it would be worth fixing for polish.

I did not see any major broken content on the live page. The main thing I would suggest is adding a little more explanation on the page or in the comments about what makes the sticky element work, such as position: sticky and the offset value like top. Overall, I thought the demo was clean and easy to follow, and I liked that the long scripture passage made the scroll behavior practical instead of forced.

Check In

How Are You Doing?

I'm doing alright. I emailed last night about how chaotic this week has been. We found out on Tuesday that we'd be moving Saturday, so I have been packing and moving nonstop from Tuesday until Saturday. We made it from Provo to Arizona last night around 11:30 Utah time, and I had zero time to do homework this week. So other than drowning in boxes and incredibly late nights with very early mornings, I have been well. Today (Sunday, 6/14/26) is the first time I've really had to look at my computer this week, and sit down and do some of my homework. So I apologize that this is late, and I hope that I can get at least some credit for the assignment